

Technical Assessment

RELEASED	DUE	SUGGESTED EFFORT
Tuesday 1 September 2026	Sunday 6 September 2026	Approx. 2 hours

This exercise is the technical stage of the selection process. It assesses how you deliver and hand over a small piece of software, not the sophistication of the product itself. A suggested effort of approximately two hours applies; this is a guideline, not a requirement.

Scope of assessment

ASSESSED	NOT ASSESSED
• Whether the solution works and can be run by someone other than the author. • Engineering hygiene: whether it is built to a standard a team could maintain. • Whether the approach reflects sound judgement given the time available.	• Product polish, visual design, or novelty of the concept. • The size or quality of the underlying language model. • The number of features delivered, or hours spent.

The task

Choose any small project you like. This exercise is about how you deliver a small piece of working software and hand it over, not which project you pick. Keep the scope tight, and use the language, tools and approach you normally work in.

A ready-made brief is offered below for anyone who would rather not spend time choosing; you are equally free to build something of your own, with your own data. **SUGGESTED BRIEF (OPTIONAL)** a small AI assistant that answers a user’s question by looking the answer up in the sample data file provided with this pack (`travel_expense_policy.csv`, a short travel-expense policy), stating clearly when the policy does not cover the question.

Whatever you build, we must be able to run and check it out of the box, with none of our own API keys, paid services, accounts or model downloads. If it uses a model, put the model behind a simple interface with an offline mode we can run, keep any real model optional, and have it read credentials from the environment. No credentials or secrets are to be committed.

Submission

1. A link to a public code repository (GitHub, GitLab or equivalent) that can be opened without granting access to a specific account. Submit the repository itself, not an archive.
2. A brief note identifying anything you wish to highlight, and what you would do with additional time.
3. Send the link to the contact who sent you this assessment **on Sunday 6 September 2026**.

Additional information

AI TOOLS The use of AI assistants is permitted. You must be able to explain all submitted work, note which tools were used, and ensure the work is your own.

QUESTIONS AND REVIEW Direct any questions to the contact who sent you this assessment. Submissions are reviewed for whether they run, whether another engineer could take them over, and the standard to which they are built.